Pawl Kit

Set up Pawl

The key in this kit is the only thing that can unlock Pawl. Setup takes about five minutes.

1 Install Pawl

It's free on the App Store. Scan the code with your iPhone camera, or search for **Pawl: App Blocker With a Key**.

Needs an iPhone 15 or newer, or an iPad with USB-C, on iOS 18 or later.

2 Pick what to block

Choose the apps and sites you want out of reach. Apple Screen Time does the blocking, and Pawl never learns their names.

3 Pair the key

When Pawl asks, plug the key into your phone's USB-C port and touch the key when your phone tells you to. Pawl remembers this key and only this key.

Giving this to someone? Let them do the setup themselves. Pawl works best when the person chooses what to block.

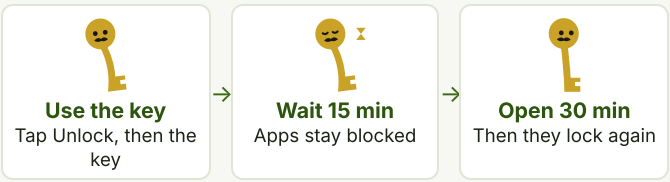
4. Put the key out of reach. Turn over. →

4. Put the key out of reach

Distance is the whole point. Whoever holds the key decides when Pawl can open. Some places that work:

- **Someone you trust** across town, like a sister, a friend, or a partner.
- **A time lock box** that won't open until its timer runs out.
- **A bank safe deposit box** or **your desk at work.**
- **Mail it to a friend** and ask them to mail it back only when you ask.

How unlocking works



Those are the starting times. You can change them in Settings. Making the wait longer happens right away. Making it shorter has to wait too.

If you lose the key

Get any USB-C FIDO2 security key and pair it on Pawl's Unlock tab. It becomes your key after the wait.

Pawl adds friction, not a wall. The owner of a phone can still turn Screen Time off. Pawl makes the 1am choice slow. There's no account, and Pawl collects no data.